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Data for “School Desegregation and Urban Change: Evidence from City Boundaries.” *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*

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1970 block-level data

Block-level data is compiled from two sources: hand-coded files that report each block’s distance to the jurisdiction/school district border and electronic Census block-level files. The raw data of each type is contained a separate folder.

Folder 1: Extracts

*This folder contains five extracts of Census block-level data, each requested as part of separate wave of data collection. The columns in these files are read in to Stata using the dictionary files **1970dictionary.dct** and **1970dictionary01.dct**. These requests were made at the Minnesota Population Center between July 2005 and December 2007. Data for the few tracts that were not available electronically at the block level are included in **block_1970_addendum_data_01.txt**.*

Folder 2: Tier_codes

These files are the results of hand-coding of each Census block in terms of distance from the jurisdiction/school district border. Coding was based on templates “outfile”-d from the Census extracts and are merged back with the original data as .txt files.

Folder 3: Main

*The do-file **block_1970_aej.do** combines the five extracts of Census block-level data (along with the addendum data added by hand). It then merges these files with the tier codes. It defines the dependent variable (e.g., housing values and rents) and the small number of available block-level control variables. Finally, it merges this block-level data with jurisdiction/school-district level data available in the District_level folder. The output file is **block_1970_aej.dta**.*

Folder 4: GIS

*The final step is to combine the block-level data with information on the racial composition of students at the nearest school. This folder contains its own “readme” files (read in order: step 1, step 2, step3). The final do file that combines the high school-level and block-level data is **mindist_hs_match.do**. The resulting output file is **block_1970_withhs_aej.dta**, which is archived in the “Main” folder. This data is combined with the final 1980 data to create the results tables.*